

KT COURIER

Final Public Experience Redesign Blueprint

Marketing • Marketplace • Authentication • Mobile • Motion • Media • Performance



Design authority document — September 2026

Scope: all public marketing, marketplace, commerce, authentication and public utility routes. Operational dashboards are explicitly excluded.

Local media source of truth: D:\KT-Courier\public\media\public\images. This location contains the downloaded media library, long white truck asset pack, red truck asset pack, white van asset pack, the 20-pose courier pack, illustrations and additional imagery. The local repository—not GitHub—is authoritative for final media assignment.

Executive Mandate

KT Courier is not being redesigned as a conventional courier website with an attractive hero. It is being rebuilt as a media-led South African commerce-and-movement experience in which the brand idea, product idea and interaction idea are the same thing: objects move through a network, across custody, geography and people.

The award-level ambition is legitimate only if the experience remains commercially useful. Awwwards historically weights design and usability heavily, with creativity and content also contributing; strong animation cannot compensate for weak product finding, unclear hierarchy, poor accessibility or a slow site. The internal 9/10 target therefore means excellent still composition, excellent usability, original interaction, strong mobile authorship, accessible fallbacks and production performance—not merely more effects.

This document is the final creative/product-design blueprint. It intentionally precedes the coding-agent .md. The later handoff must translate this blueprint into exact source-file edits, route build order, local asset processing and acceptance checks without changing the design direction.

Decision	Locked Direction
Visual thesis	South African commerce in movement.
Conceptual protagonist	The order / parcel and its changing custody.
Primary visual protagonist	Long white truck — network scale and flagship movement.
Human protagonist	Courier — responsibility, handoff, trust and arrival.
Local movement actor	White van — neighbourhood / marketplace / last-mile.
Heavy-movement actor	Red truck — freight / capacity / high-intensity counterpoint.
Desktop character	Cinematic marketing + editorial commerce.
Mobile character	A dedicated consumer app experience in the browser.
Commerce principle	Interface organizes merchandise; merchandise creates atmosphere.
Motion principle	KT moves objects; it does not teleport them.
Implementation principle	Evidence → static composition → motion → code. Never effects-first.

Document Map

1. Research Synthesis and Reference Lessons
2. Product Truth and Public-Site Operating Modes
3. Brand World: Type, Colour, Grid and Geometry
4. Media and Protagonist System
5. Homepage Master Storyboard
6. Marketing Route Families
7. Marketplace and Category Experience
8. Product, Cart and Checkout Interaction
9. Mobile Application Experience
10. Global Navigation and Footer
11. Motion System and Engine Ownership
12. Transition Grammar
13. Accessibility and Reduced Motion
14. Media Pipeline and Local Asset Registry
15. Performance Architecture
16. Component and Route Architecture
17. Build Order and Acceptance Gates
18. Anti-Patterns and Rejection Criteria
- Appendix A. Compulsory Motion Allocation
- Appendix B. Research Sources

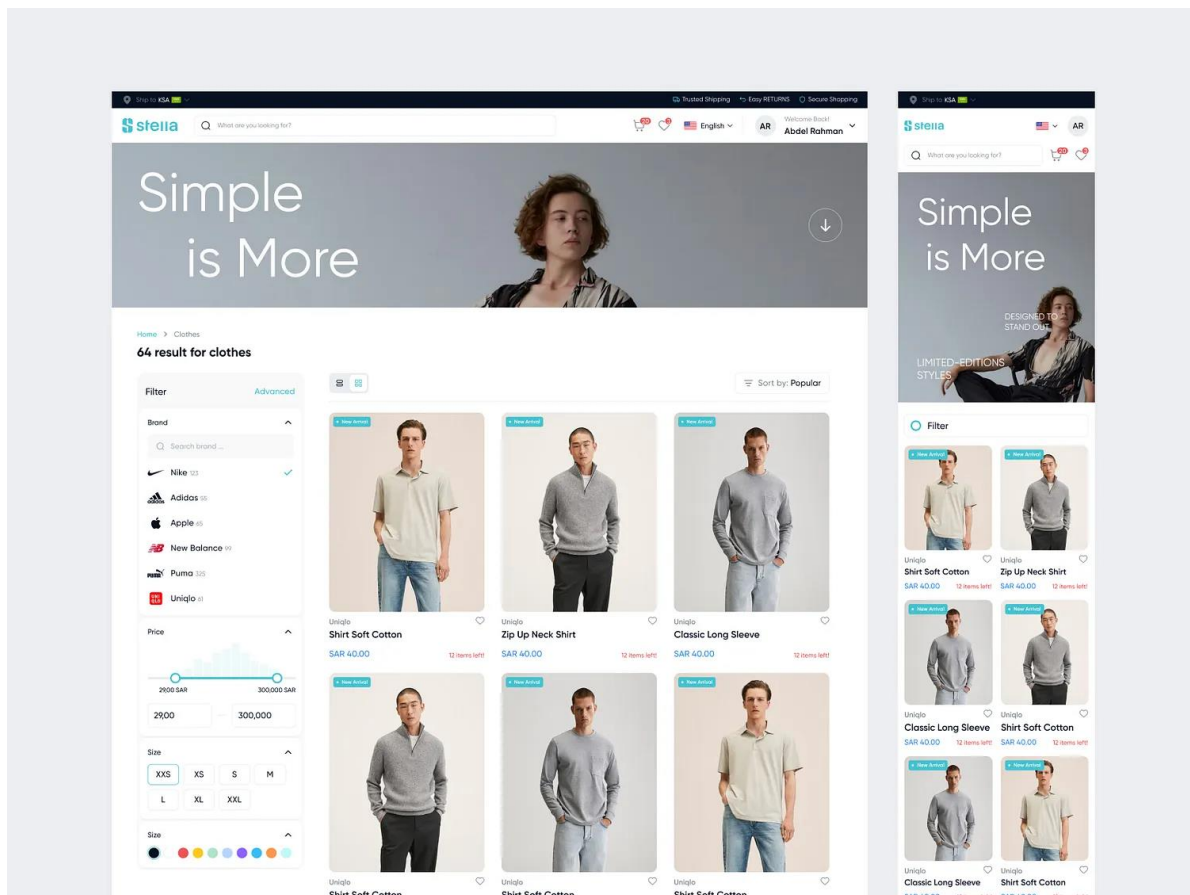
1. Research Synthesis and Reference Lessons

The final direction is not a collage of references. Each reference contributes one transferable system principle; surface style is rejected unless it belongs to KT product truth.

Evidence	Transferable Principle	KT Rule
United Carriers	Continuous logistics narrative; isolated transport objects; side-view ↔ top-view state changes; road/object continuity; a scene begins before the previous scene fully disappears.	Do not copy truck/ship/plane sequence. KT follows commerce → parcel → vehicle → courier → customer.
White Desert	Layered section takeovers, atmosphere as transition logic, quiet/loud pacing, operational geography inside cinematic photography, authored footer finale.	Do not copy Antarctic luxury tone; transfer spatial takeover and pacing discipline.
Oryzo / Lusion	Product at centre; realistic visual world; seamless transitions; narrow UI palette; tool follows idea.	Reinforces evidence-first and no effects-first implementation.
Lando Norris / OFF+BRAND	Subject-derived speed, WebGL/3D/motion only where racing identity supports it; responsive performance discipline.	KT motion must derive from route, custody, load, handoff, track and arrival.
Royal Beverage reference	Oversized typography behind a foreground protagonist; object occludes type; still frame works like a poster.	Hero composition principle, not beverage styling.
Image-stack / fan references	Compressed media mass expands into active item; perspective/depth creates category discovery.	Use for marketplace/category discovery, not every section.
Hover media-list references	Stable text index activates relevant media on pointer/focus.	Use for services, categories and role selectors.
White Desert footer reference	Footer as final designed viewport with giant type, not a utility afterthought.	Adopt as KT finale principle.
Luxury/fashion commerce references	Large product media, minimal chrome, disciplined categories and filters, image-led value.	Apply only to shop/category/PDP commerce modes; not to all marketing routes.
Baymard research	Product finding, mobile category access, filtering, image evaluation, cart/checkout clarity remain conversion fundamentals.	Creative motion must not hide browsing, filtering, state or price truth.



Reference plate: oversized type + foreground object + depth hierarchy.



Reference plate: mobile/desktop commerce information hierarchy — not a style to copy.

2. Product Truth and Public-Site Operating Modes

KT is a hybrid marketplace and logistics network. The redesign must keep the product legible to four major audiences: shoppers/senders, merchants/stores, drivers/fleet participants, and internal-facing partner/business prospects. Public design cannot imply features, coverage, ETAs, rankings or guarantees that the backend does not actually support.

Public Experience Modes

Mode	Representative Routes	Behaviour
Cinematic Marketing	/, /services, service detail, /about, /coverage-areas, /join, /careers, /membership	Protagonists, visual worlds, scene overlap, route geometry, image fields, strong scroll choreography.
Editorial Commerce	/shop, /shop/categories, store/vendor discovery	Campaign-scale type and imagery, category worlds, merchant windows, editorial rails, controlled product grids.
Transactional Commerce	category PLPs, search, PDP, cart	Fast browsing, product evaluation, filters, offer truth, object continuity, restrained motion.
Quiet Utility	auth, checkout, FAQ, contact, legal, safety	Clarity, trust, minimal motion, excellent forms and typography.

Master Narrative

DISCOVER → CHOOSE → PREPARE → COLLECT → CARRY → ROUTE → HANDOFF → ARRIVE. This is the public-site narrative spine. Routes may expose different parts, but they should feel like the same world.

Commerce Narrative

BROWSE → EVALUATE → CONFIGURE → ADD → REVIEW → PAY → MOVE. Commerce microinteractions inherit the same physical law as marketing: state changes are visible and spatially continuous.

Truth Rule

Any copy or interface state that claims availability, delivery time, stock, price, service coverage, ratings or merchant status must come from verified backend data. Art direction never fabricates operational certainty.

Dashboard Boundary

Operational dashboards are excluded. Shared tokens can later inform them, but no dashboard routes, workbenches or internal operations surfaces should be redesigned as part of this project.

3. Brand World: Type, Colour, Grid and Geometry

Typography

Creative decision: ABC Diatype as the public-facing type family, paired with ABC Diatype Mono for operational metadata. Diatype is suitable because it can hold both editorial scale and technical precision without pushing KT into generic geometric SaaS or fashion-only styling. Commercial licensing is required. The coding agent must only activate Diatype if licensed webfont files are supplied locally. Until then, retain Schibsted Grotesk as the production-safe fallback, with Geist/another already licensed mono for operational labels.

Role	Face/Weight	Rule
Display	Diatype Heavy/Black	Hero/finale architecture, giant cropped words, selected campaign statements.
Editorial headings	Diatype Bold/Heavy	Section titles, category names, service chapter titles.
Navigation/UI	Diatype Medium	Header, tabs, filters, buttons, bottom navigation.
Body	Diatype Regular	Marketing and commerce copy.
Operational signal	Diatype Mono	Tracking IDs, route codes, time, counts, service indices, metadata.

Colour System

Token	Value	Primary Use
Carbon	#0E1012	Primary dark environment / industrial field.
Ink	#111318	Primary text on light surfaces.
Paper	#F3F1EA	Primary light environment; warmer than sterile white.
Graphite	#59626A	Secondary text / metadata.
Mist	#D9DEE2	Dividers, subtle surfaces, large faded typography.
KT Cobalt	#347CFB	Brand signal, route/motion graphics, large display accents.
Deep Cobalt	#2A64DD	Functional accessible blue for small controls/text where required.
Signal Red	#CF2930	Urgency / kinetic accent / true errors; scarce by design.

Colour ratio rule: roughly 70–80% neutral structure, 15–20% media/environmental colour, 5–10% brand signals. The richer the media field, the quieter the UI palette. Red and cobalt gain value through scarcity.

Grid and Spatial Rhythm

Desktop primary artboard: 1440×900. Secondary desktop: 1366×768. Tablet: 820×1180. Mobile: 430×930, 390×844 and 360×800. Ultra-wide should expand negative space and media scale without stretching text measure.

Campaign/marketing grids may break deliberately, but text alignment must still derive from a consistent column system. Commerce grids remain more disciplined because scanning and comparison depend on spatial regularity.

No two consecutive marketing viewports should be primarily text. Static composition must already feel authored before motion is applied.

Clipping / Shape Grammar

Level	Geometry	Use
Quiet geometry	Subtle crop, minimal corner treatment.	Long-form reading, basic commerce media, utility blocks.
Signature KT clip	Forward cut, slot, inset, docked node, route-corner geometry.	Categories, services, stats, merchant imagery, CTAs.
Cinematic geometry	Large masks, full-viewport cutovers, object-shaped takeovers.	Hero, flagship section transitions, selected route transitions.

4. Media and Protagonist System

The local media library is now a production asset system, not a miscellaneous image folder. The eventual coding agent must begin by inspecting the local path visually and semantically before using any image.

AUTHORITATIVE LOCAL MEDIA ROOT: D:\KT-Courier\public\media\public\images

Protagonist Hierarchy

Asset Family	Narrative Role	Primary Jobs
Long white truck	Flagship network protagonist	Hero entrance, giant-type occlusion, trailer mask, side-view movement, top-view route, network/coverage callbacks, selected route transition carry.
White van	Local/last-mile protagonist	Marketplace pickup, local services, van-door handoff, neighbourhood movement.
Red truck	Heavy freight / visual intensity	Freight/capacity chapter, larger network scale, selected dark/high-energy sequences.
Courier — 20 pose pack	Human responsibility protagonist	Pickup, loading/unloading, carrying, handoff, arrival, Join/driver stories, support/trust media.
Parcel/order	Conceptual protagonist	Connects merchant, vehicle, courier and recipient. Can become route data, label/barcode, cart object and delivery confirmation.
Illustrations	Supporting explanatory material	Empty states, process explanations, selected service/auth/support moments; never replace real media where human/physical credibility matters.



Primary protagonist source: long white truck. Neutral mass, high mask potential, hero authority.



Secondary freight protagonist: red truck. Use as rare intensity/capacity signal, not as the universal KT vehicle.

Media Taxonomy

Each local file must be classified into one primary role and any valid secondary roles. The implementation inventory should also record orientation, aspect ratio, pixel dimensions, alpha/transparency, dominant focal region, text-safe region, mobile crop tolerance, parallax tolerance, mask tolerance, candidate routes and whether the file is a source master or runtime derivative.

Image Selection Rule

Do not aim to use 90 or 100 images merely because they exist. Use every asset that earns a specific compositional or informational role; reject duplicate, weak, off-brand or redundant media. A 9/10 experience is created by role discipline, not by image volume.

5. Homepage Master Storyboard

The homepage is a sequence of physical states, not a stack of sections. Multiple rows below may occur inside the same pinned viewport or overlap spatially. The visitor should feel that one world transforms into the next.

State	Driver	Composition / Motion	Level	Job
00 — Seal	Automatic	Carbon planes meet around the simplified KT mark. Asymmetric pressure builds; a controlled seam break reveals a cobalt signal.	7	Brand arrival without a long loader.
01 — Mark Through Camera	Automatic	KT mark scales toward viewer and becomes the reveal mask. Final optical blur only near the end.	8	Transition into real page world.
02 — Hero Still	Static-first	Paper/neutral field. Oversized KT COURIERS typography behind long white truck. Shop and Send actions visible immediately.	10	Primary campaign still must already pass award-level test.
03 — Truck Entry	Automatic→settle	Truck enters from left, crosses typography and settles slightly below optical centre. Wheels/ground baseline create mass.	9	Introduce movement as product.
04 — Environment Moves First	Scroll	Truck holds; text, road signal, tiny metadata, foreground markers and wheel motion respond before truck translates.	8	Weight/inertia rather than floating SVG motion.
05 — Trailer Takeover	Scroll	Truck starts travelling; white trailer increases until it becomes a near-full-screen material plane.	9	Signature material handoff.
06 — Marketplace Reveal	Scroll	Trailer plane masks into media/category world. Five category media states break apart through perspective and clipping.	8	Commerce enters without hard section reset.
07 — Category / Merchant World	Scroll + pointer	Image crawler, active-category media, merchant fragments, product imagery. One selected visual can take possession of viewport.	8	Show breadth of KT marketplace.
08 — Choice Becomes Parcel	Scroll	Intensity falls. Merchant preparation, hands, packaging, label/parcel detail.	5	Translate desire into physical order.
09 — Local Collection	Scroll	White van enters. Door state changes; courier enters with parcel.	8	Marketplace becomes delivery.
10 — Custody Handoff	Scroll	Parcel visibly transfers to courier/KT. Text and tracking metadata appear as evidence around action.	9	Human responsibility/trust moment.
11 — Route / Tracking	Scroll	Camera shifts to top-view states. Road geometry, city imagery and route line carry the parcel through network.	9	Operational credibility.
12 — Network Scale	Scroll	Long white truck returns; red truck may appear as freight/capacity escalation. Services/coverage facts occupy sides while actor persists.	8	Show KT beyond single parcel.
13 — Arrival	Scroll	Courier/human imagery returns; mechanical intensity falls. Handoff/recipient resolves the journey.	5	Emotional payoff.

Hero CTA architecture

Do not use two generic adjacent buttons. Shop and Send should have distinct spatial territories while remaining equally discoverable. Desktop can place commerce intent bottom-left and delivery intent bottom-right; mobile stacks them in a single thumb-reachable decision zone.

Static hero acceptance

Freeze immediately after the truck settles. The frame must function as a campaign poster: strong hierarchy, meaningful negative space, readable actions, clean truck silhouette, no motion needed to rescue composition.

Scroll length

Do not create an exhausting 4,000–6,000px hero pin. The opening should resolve quickly; major hero scroll chapter should be roughly 130–180vh and hand off to the next world. Longer chapters require demonstrated narrative value.

Copy discipline

Keep the giant background type brand-led. Supporting marketing copy should be concise and product truthful. Avoid paragraph-heavy hero writing and unverified metrics.

6. Marketing Route Families

Route Family	Visual Operating Mode	Direction	Motion
/services	Movement Atlas	Interactive service index + changing protagonist/media world. Sticky cursor/hover media on desktop; tap/swipe on mobile.	High
/services/*	Service-specific movement story	Service truth determines actor, photography and pace. Preserve pricing/eligibility/product facts.	Medium–High
/about	Ecosystem story	Floating/asymmetrical media field connecting merchant, order, movement, recipient. Quiet editorial pauses.	Medium
/coverage-areas	Geography protagonist	Route lines, South African city media, top-view actor states, configured region/corridor truth.	High
/join	Role worlds	Store / Driver / Promoter selector changes media and visual actor. Clear path into verification/workflow.	Medium
/careers	People behind movement	Human/operations photography, role stories, real open-role data.	Medium
/membership	Network/value story	Member value, eligibility and operational benefits with restrained media choreography.	Medium
/contact	Support utility	Fast, quiet, confident. One authored media composition only.	Low
/faq	Editorial utility	Excellent findability, search/accordion, minimal motion.	Low
/developers	Technical signal world	A legitimate location for pixel/digital transition treatment and mono metadata.	Medium
Legal/Safety/Accessibility	Reading mode	Typography-first, no spectacle, consistent shell and accessibility.	Low

Marketing Composition Rules

Each flagship marketing route receives one dominant protagonist/material and one clear visual thesis. Do not distribute every truck/courier asset across every route. Treat media as spatial actors, and whenever possible let the next scene inherit material from the outgoing scene rather than reset.

At least one quiet viewport must separate major high-intensity moments. Continuous 9/10 visual noise becomes 5/10 pacing.

7. Marketplace and Category Experience

Apple/fashion research applies to commerce discovery only. The marketplace should be more editorial than a standard multi-vendor catalogue, but product finding remains non-negotiable.

/shop — Marketplace Campaign + Discovery Hub

Chapter	Direction
Threshold	Oversized SHOP typography integrated with category/merchant media. Search available immediately. Mobile Shop tab active.
Five-category world	Five top-level category states exist as one interactive visual object rather than five identical cards. Hover/focus/tap changes active media.
Perspective / media crawler	Category imagery expands from compressed stack into depth; user controls movement. No auto-rotating touch carousel.
Merchant window	Selected local merchants shown with high-quality hero media and a minimal entry action.
New/curated products	Clean product grid with occasional editorial interruptions; no SaaS cards.
Story/recommendation rails	Multiple carousel families with different jobs; transactional rails stay calm.
Commerce finale	Campaign-scale statement/media moment before branded footer; do not end with generic newsletter card.

/shop/categories — Category Atlas

Create this as a flagship route, even if the current local tree contains partial scaffolding. The five categories become five authored visual rooms. Each category receives dominant media, supporting crops/cutouts, oversized type, short descriptor, and a route transition created by the selected media itself. Category naming remains plain and scannable.

Category Route — Editorial Opening + Real PLP

Top of category route may be art-directed: large title, dominant category image, subcategory rail, selected merchant/story and one curated product set. Once the user reaches the comparison area, the interface becomes a disciplined product list with strong filtering, sorting, result count and applied-filter visibility.

Desktop PLP Rules

Large desktop defaults to 4 product columns when image quality supports it; reduce to 3 at narrower desktop/tablet widths.

No generic card shadows or rounded SaaS tiles. Image field, title, merchant/brand, price and necessary availability/variant data are enough.

Filters are sticky and category-specific. Do not show useless facets simply because a generic filter component supports them.

Applied filters remain visible. Back navigation must restore filter, sort and scroll state.

Grid may contain sparse editorial interruptions, but never so many that visual scanning breaks.

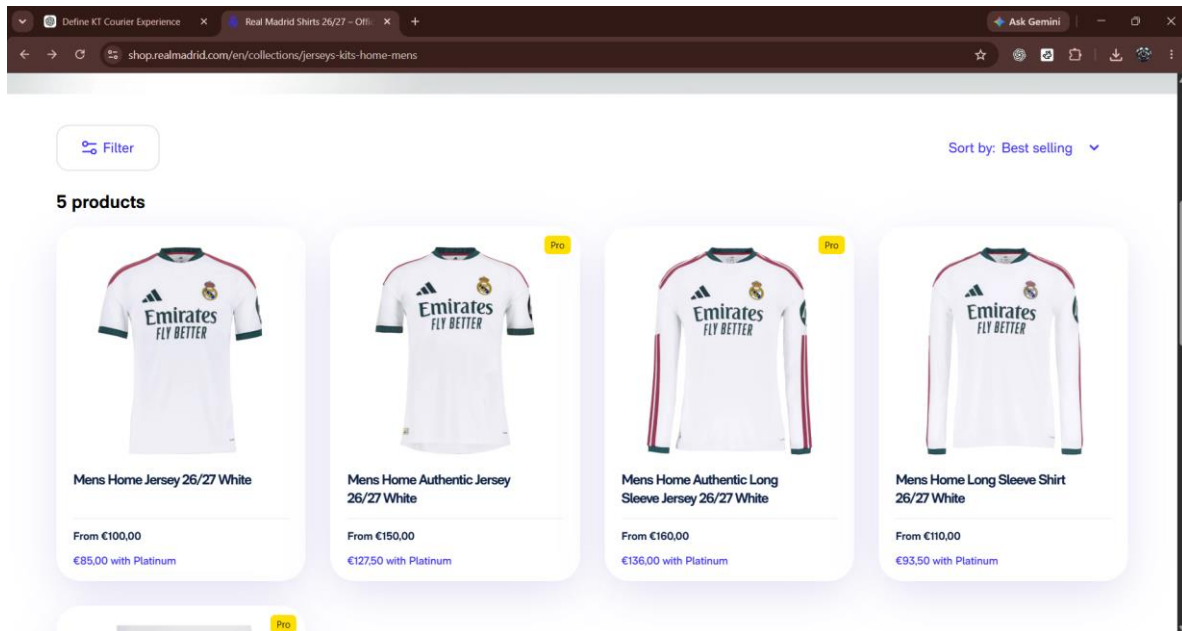
Product Tile / Commerce Microinteraction

Hover/focus swaps to a genuinely informative alternate image when available; never hover-scale everything.

Simple products may expose compact Add to Cart / Buy Now actions. Products requiring size/variant/modifier choice show Choose Options instead.

Wishlist/favorite can exist if backend truth supports it; do not display inactive decorative hearts without a real function.

Product card is fully keyboard navigable; hover experiences have focus/tap equivalents.



Reference plate: clear product count, filter/sort hierarchy, large merchandise fields.



Fresh drops & all-time favorites, find your next pair

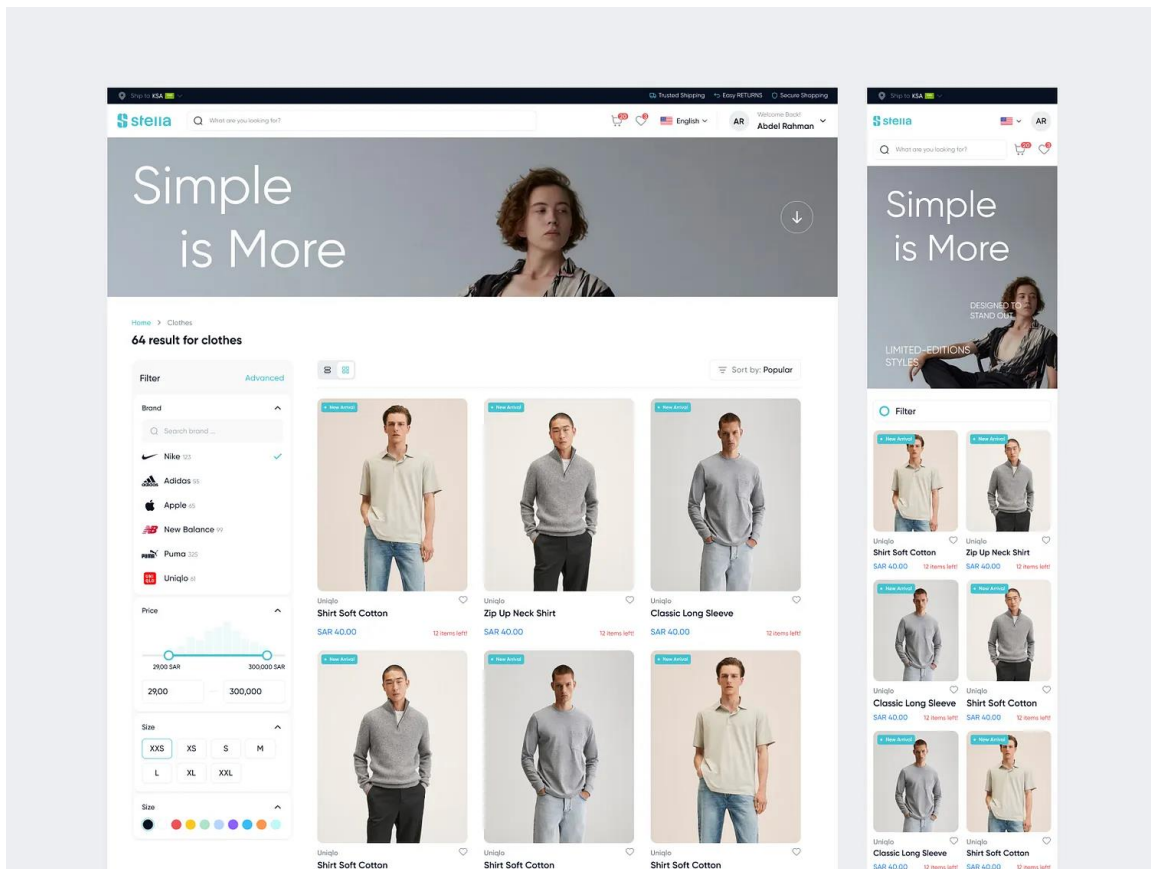
View All Product



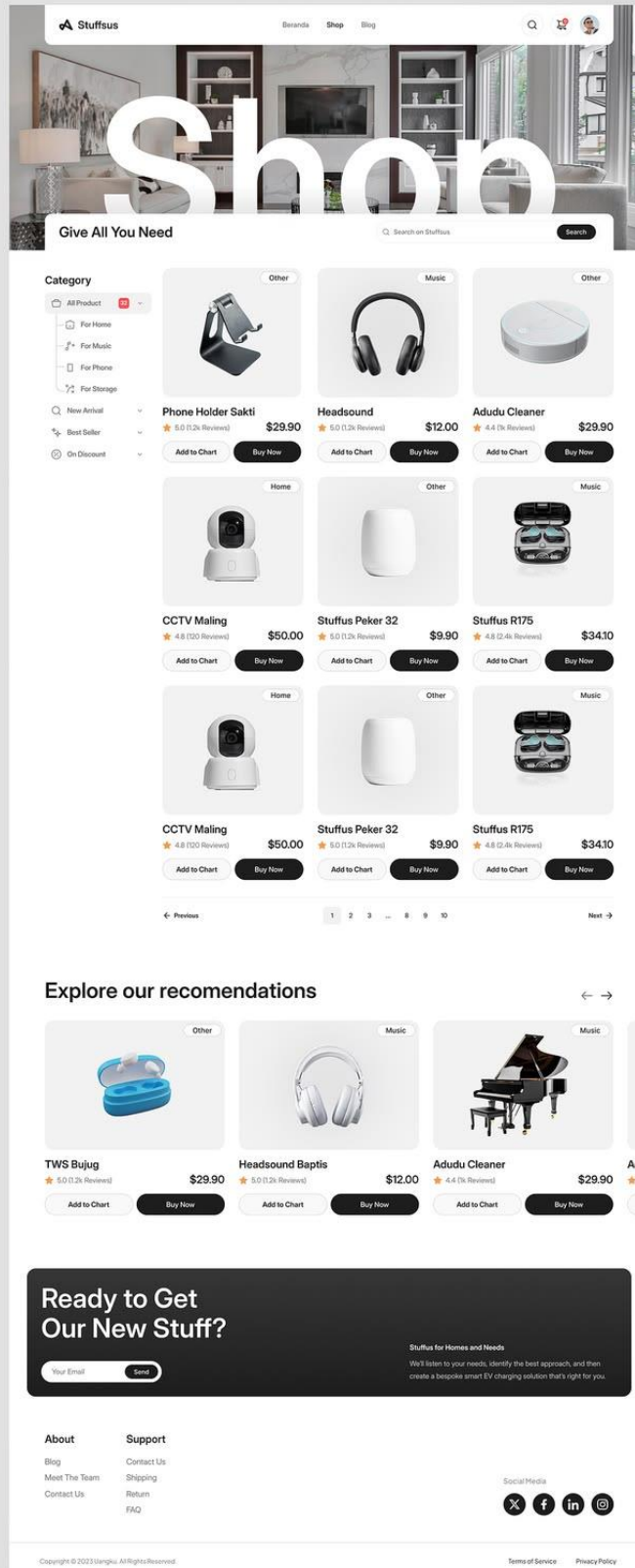
Designed for Movement, Built For Impact.



Reference plate: campaign-style commerce and editorial product interruptions.



Reference plate: marketplace filtering structure and mobile adaptation.



Reference plate: big SHOP threshold and full-route commerce rhythm.

8. Product, Cart and Checkout Interaction

Product Detail Page

PDP is product-obsessed, not homepage-cinematic. The media world dominates; the purchasing plane is calm, sticky on desktop and highly legible. Media roles should include primary hero, alternate angle, detail, scale/context, packaging/contents, lifestyle and optional video/transparent object where appropriate. Vendor media rules should eventually enforce sufficient coverage without forcing identical creative treatment across food, fashion, wellness and homeware.

Area	Direction
Desktop top	~60–66% media world + ~34–40% purchase plane. Sticky product information while the primary gallery scrolls.
Media gallery	3–4 images: composed mosaic. 5+: editorial vertical gallery. Tap/click zoom. Product-specific video only if meaningful.
Variant state	Changing colour/size/offer updates media, stock, price and delivery state in place. Motion handles local layout change; no full route reset.
Multi-seller	Present Best Available Offer based on actual backend logic; expandable Compare Sellers surface. Do not invent ranking criteria.
Delivery	Surface only real backend truth: in-stock, calculated at checkout, or actual supported estimate. Never fabricate “arrives tomorrow”.
Below fold	Story/detail → specifications/material/ingredients → merchant → delivery/returns → same merchant → related products.

Product → PDP Shared Transition

On supported routes, selected product media persists from grid tile to PDP media position in approximately 300–500ms. The transition is short enough for shopping and long enough to preserve object continuity. Back navigation restores prior PLP state. Use Motion layoutId or a custom portal/GSAP Flip path; do not rely on experimental framework-level View Transitions as the sole production mechanism.

Add-to-Cart Signature Motion

State	Behaviour
1. Pending	Button acknowledges input; no product flight yet.
2. Server success	Only after authoritative cart mutation succeeds does the visual transfer begin.
3. Proxy detach	A clipped/isolated copy of the product image detaches into a fixed overlay layer.
4. Flight	Shallow arc / geometry interpolation to cart target. Roughly 450–700ms desktop; shorter on mobile.
5. Cart receipt	Cart icon/tab responds, badge updates and drawer/sheet begins opening.
6. Item confirmation	New line item is visibly highlighted; user can continue shopping, review cart or checkout.
Failure	No flight. Resolve button and show clear inline error.

Cart

Preserve merchant grouping. Cart drawer is immediate feedback; /cart remains the deliberate review surface. Each line shows product image, selected variant/modifiers, quantity, price, availability and clear remove/edit affordances. Sticky summary remains authoritative. Avoid cluttering confirmation with multiple upsells.

Checkout

Checkout intentionally suppresses cinematic ambition. Keep the current backend sequence truthful while presenting a calm visitor-facing progression: Contact → Delivery → Review → Payment. Desktop uses form left + sticky order summary right. Mobile uses a single-column flow with expandable summary. Commercial changes—price, quantity, stock, delivery fee—must be explicit and acknowledged before payment.

Confirmation

Confirmation is the narrative endpoint. Replace generic success-card treatment with a restrained branded resolution such as “IT’S MOVING.” paired with actual order reference, merchant grouping, next state and tracking/support actions. A subtle parcel/courier visual can re-enter without delaying task completion.

9. Mobile Application Experience

Mobile is a separate composition and navigation system. The goal is to make KT feel like a premium consumer app in the browser, not a desktop page collapsed into one column.

Persistent Bottom Navigation

Tab	Destination
Home	Homepage / KT world
Shop	Marketplace and categories
Send	Start delivery / quote journey
Cart	Cart + badge + add-to-cart destination
Account	Login/account state

The bottom bar appears after the homepage opening reveal and remains stable across general public/commerce navigation. It respects safe-area inset, always uses text labels, and uses cobalt for active state. Red is reserved primarily for cart/attention/error signals. Checkout and focused auth flows suppress the bar to prevent competing navigation.

Mobile Header

Use a compact top bar for context: KT mark/back, route title where needed, search in Shop contexts, menu for secondary destinations. Replace the current “search + cart + hamburger only” mobile shell with a top-context + bottom-primary model.

Mobile Hero Cinematography

Do not fit the entire long truck into a small screen. Crop through it; allow cab/trailer to move across a portrait viewport so its scale is felt.

Stack giant typography vertically and let the truck occlude different letter regions.

Reduce long pins, pointer-reactive effects and inertial lag. Native touch scrolling is primary.

Shop and Send actions live in a thumb-reachable decision zone after the reveal.

Mobile Commerce

/shop behaves like an app-shop home: visible search, category paths, swipeable editorial category deck and stable Shop tab.

Category PLP uses two columns by default, with a sticky Filter / Sort utility surface above the bottom bar.

Filters open in a full-height sheet with applied-filter summary and a clear “Show X results” action.

PDP opens with full-width swipe gallery, image count and zoom. Purchase controls follow immediately. A sticky price/Add bar can sit above the global bottom nav after the primary controls leave view.

Add-to-cart product proxy travels downward to the Cart tab; badge updates and cart sheet rises. Reduced-motion users receive badge/sheet feedback without flight animation.

Mobile Marketing

Cinematic routes remain cinematic, but use portrait compositions: partial protagonists, vertical masks, touch-controlled media rails, shorter pins, fewer simultaneous depth layers. Bottom navigation provides stable orientation beneath the changing worlds.

10. Global Navigation and Footer

Desktop Header

Primary architecture: Shop, Send, Services, Coverage, Business. Utilities: Join, Sign in/Account, Cart, Get a Quote. Header must be contrast-adaptive over light/dark media, but should not constantly morph. Services opens as a real atlas/menu surface with full keyboard support and Escape/close behavior. Header collision bugs in the current site are non-negotiable defects to eliminate.

Expanded / Curved Menu

The compulsory curved-menu behavior should live in the global expanded menu, where geometry is meaningful and infrequent. The menu can enter with a curved or masked boundary derived from KT route geometry, while navigation content itself remains conventional and scannable.

Footer

Footer is the final designed viewport. Oversized KT COURIERS / brand statement occupies substantial visual territory. Utility links form a disciplined grid around or beneath it. On mobile, the type remains enormous and cropped rather than shrinking into a conventional footer heading. Persistent bottom navigation ends or transitions before footer utility content so fixed UI never obscures legal/navigation links.

11. Motion System and Engine Ownership

Motion exists to explain physical relationships, preserve continuity and create subject-derived rhythm. It is not a quality layer applied after layout.

Engine	Ownership	Examples
GSAP + ScrollTrigger	Macro narrative motion	Hero/truck sequences, pinning, section takeovers, route drawing, masks, long parallax, shared protagonist journeys, camera-state choreography.
Lenis	Temporal substrate	Desktop fine-pointer smoothness only when it improves continuity. One scroll clock. Disable for reduced motion and generally for touch/mobile.
Motion for React	Local state / layout	layoutId/shared media, variant selection, drawers/sheets, cart line insertion, tabs, local springs, focus/hover/tap state.
CSS / WAAPI	Lightweight interaction	Simple hover/focus/press/reveal where a heavy engine is unnecessary.
Three/R3F	Exceptional spatial need only	Only if a scene cannot reach quality/performance targets with prepared 2D assets/CSS 3D. Do not introduce WebGL as a prestige badge.

Motion Timing Character

Primary sequence rhythm: MOVE → HOLD → COUNTER-MOVE → OVERLAP → HANDOFF → RESOLVE → READ.

Major route transitions should usually stay in the ~350–1000ms band. Longer than ~1–1.5s must be justified by visible narrative value, never by awards-site habit.

Heavy actors should show inertia: surrounding environment can respond before the vehicle body moves. Lightweight UI can respond immediately.

Avoid universal fade-up, hover-scale-everything, mechanical stagger everywhere, random parallax, meaningless marquees and multiple engines controlling the same transform.

12. Transition Grammar

Family	Mechanic	Best Use
Object Carry	Same truck, parcel, courier or product survives across scene/route boundary.	Hero→route; category tile→category page; product tile→PDP.
Material Takeover	Physical surface grows until it becomes transition plane.	White trailer→marketplace; road→tracking; van door→next scene.
Layer Takeover	Incoming viewport rises/slides over outgoing while previous remains visible underneath.	Marketing chapter changes; White Desert-inspired spatial handoff.
Image Expansion	Selected media expands to full-stage destination.	Category selection; merchant story; gallery→detail.
Foreground Occlusion	Actor crosses close to camera and hides a world change.	Courier carrying parcel; vehicle crossing frame.
Pixel Transition	Real visual information breaks/reforms into a digital state.	Tracking/developer/system context only; one signature use, not global decoration.
Quiet Route Transition	Short opacity/position/shared-element continuity.	Auth, legal, contact, utility routes.

Every major transition must identify source state, persistent actor/material, destination state, readiness condition and fallback. If a transition cannot explain that relationship, use a quieter transition instead.

13. Accessibility and Reduced Motion

All hover-only media behavior has keyboard focus and touch/tap equivalent.

Reduced motion is parallel art direction, not “disable everything”: preserve composition, content and state feedback while removing long pins, huge camera zooms, pointer lag and nonessential transforms.

Custom/sticky cursors only on fine-pointer devices; never hide the native cursor where precision or accessibility suffers.

Focus must remain visible across light/dark/photographic surfaces. Drawers and sheets trap focus appropriately and restore focus on close.

Mobile touch targets target at least ~44×44 CSS px where possible. Bottom-nav labels are always visible.

Colour is never the sole carrier of error, selection, stock or delivery state.

Decorative images use empty alt; meaningful product/merchant/people images receive specific alt text derived from actual content. Automated filenames are not acceptable alt text.

Route transitions must never interrupt screen-reader navigation or leave focus on unmounted content.

Checkout and auth receive the quietest motion mode by default.

14. Media Pipeline and Local Asset Registry

The future coding-agent handoff must instruct the agent to treat the local media root as the authoritative source and perform media inventory before visual implementation. GitHub cannot be assumed complete because category/media work and downloaded packs are local-only.

Stage	Requirement
1. Scan	Recursively enumerate all media folders and files under D:\KT-Courier\public\media\public\images.
2. Inspect	Generate dimensions/hash metadata and visually inspect anonymous filenames. Identify truck/van/courier packs and illustration folders.
3. Deduplicate	Hash exact duplicates and flag near-duplicates / alternate crops. Never delete source masters without explicit review.
4. Classify	Assign media role(s), route candidates, orientation, focal region, text-safe zone, mobile suitability, transparency and transition suitability.
5. Semantic naming	Create curated runtime names/manifests; keep original masters archived/local.
6. Derive	Use Sharp/Node pipeline to create WebP runtime derivatives at role-appropriate widths/quality. Preserve alpha for protagonists. Keep SVG as vector.
7. Register	Create typed media manifest used by routes/scenes. No direct random path imports throughout components.
8. Load by scene	Only load assets needed for current route and upcoming scene. Later chapters warm shortly before entry.
9. Verify	Check alpha edges, crop integrity, responsive sizes, LCP choice and mobile crops manually.

Suggested Manifest Fields

id, sourcePath, runtimePath(s), width, height, aspectRatio, alpha, role, subject, category/service tags, focalX/focalY, textSafeRegion, desktopCrop, mobileCrop, parallaxSafe, maskSafe, protagonistFamily, pose/viewpoint, transitionUse, altText, decorative, priority/LCP eligibility.

15. Performance Architecture

Area	Rule
LCP	One clearly identified first-viewport LCP asset per route. Do not lazy-load it. Use high fetch priority only where genuinely critical.
Below-fold media	Lazy-load. Do not preload entire carousels or protagonist packs.
Scene manifests	Homepage starts with opening/hero assets; later scenes warm progressively. Shop loads visible category/product media, not marketing trucks.
Images	Responsive dimensions/sizes are explicit. Photography gets WebP derivatives; transparent actor WebP is visually verified against PNG source.
Animation	Prefer transform/opacity/clip where possible. Avoid layout-thrashing scroll handlers. GSAP cleanup is mandatory in React.
Smooth scroll	Single clock. No stacked smooth-scroll libraries. Touch remains native unless proven otherwise.
WebGL	Not default. Use only where DOM/CSS/prepared assets cannot meet art direction without unacceptable complexity.
Core Web Vitals target	Aim for LCP $\leq 2.5s$ p75 production, INP $\leq 200ms$, CLS ≤ 0.1 ; internal aspiration tighter on key public routes.
Font loading	Local licensed WOFF2, subset/weights intentionally chosen, font-display configured to avoid invisible text and layout shock.
Analytics	Measure real route performance and conversion after launch. Awards attention is not a substitute for business outcomes.

16. Component and Route Architecture

The redesign should preserve domain logic and route truth while replacing the visual architecture. Do not ask the coding agent to “make current components prettier.” The public experience should be rebuilt into a clear composition layer over existing business/data services.

Preserve

Backend domain and ZAR/payment logic.
 Marketplace/search/filter data contracts.
 Merchant grouping and authoritative cart/checkout calculations.
 Authentication and route protection behavior.
 11-service product truth / configured coverage data.
 South African media that remains visually strong.
 Accessibility landmarks/skip-link intent where correct.

Rebuild / Replace

Homepage visual scene components and current rigid category scrub.
 Generic public Button/Card visual grammar.
 Public header/mobile navigation shell.
 Footer into typographic finale.
 Marketplace landing/category atlas/product tile visual system.
 Auth composition styling.
 Current ad-hoc route transition layer into the defined transition families.
 Monolithic public CSS into route/system modules or a disciplined public design-system layer.

Install / Add

Motion for React (`motion` package) for local shared-layout/state motion.
 Typed media manifest / scene manifest system.
 Local Sharp preprocessing script(s) for media derivatives.
 Mobile bottom-navigation application shell.
 Add-to-cart flight/portal layer.
 Route-state preservation for PLP filters/sort/scroll where not already robust.

17. Build Order and Acceptance Gates

Build Stage	Gate
Phase A — Inventory / foundation	Local media audit, font availability, final tokens, route matrix, shared shell. No flagship motion yet.
Phase B — Static flagship frames	Hero still, marketplace category frame, handoff frame, route frame, footer finale. Desktop + mobile static screenshots must pass before motion.
Phase C — Homepage choreography	Opening, truck, trailer takeover, marketplace, van/courier, route, arrival, finale; reduced-motion path in parallel.
Phase D — Marketing routes	Services/Atlas, service details, About, Coverage, Join, Careers, Membership, utility pages.
Phase E — Commerce shell	Shop, category atlas, category PLP, merchant/store, search, product tiles.
Phase F — Transactional interaction	PDP, product→PDP shared transition, add-to-cart flight, cart drawer/page, checkout/confirmation.
Phase G — Mobile app shell	Bottom navigation, mobile hero, category deck, filter sheet, mobile PDP/cart integration.
Phase H — QA/performance	Manual viewport matrix, keyboard/touch/reduced motion, a11y, build/lint/type/unit/integration, performance profiling. No Playwright.

Manual Acceptance Matrix

1440×900 desktop

1366×768 desktop

820×1180 tablet

430×930 mobile

390×844 mobile

360×800 mobile

keyboard-only

touch

fast-scroll / reverse-scroll

reduced motion

slow network / media fallback

Award-Level Acceptance Test

Dimension	Pass Condition
Still composition	Hero, flagship midpoints, category atlas and footer remain compelling with motion paused.
Originality	No generic SaaS/bento/glass/AI-blue visual grammar; interaction is derived from KT product truth.
Usability	Shop/Send/Services/categories/cart/search remain obvious. Filters and purchase state are never hidden by spectacle.

Motion	Transitions preserve relationships, respond cleanly to fast input and never chase the scroll.
Mobile	Feels deliberately authored as an application, not compressed desktop.
Accessibility	Keyboard/touch/focus/reduced-motion paths are complete and visually intentional.
Performance	Large media library is scene-loaded; flagship interactions remain smooth without preload theatre.
Content truth	No invented ETAs, coverage, ratings, stock, seller ranking or metrics.
Engineering	No transform ownership conflicts, orphaned public components, broken header overlap or route-state loss.

18. Anti-Patterns and Rejection Criteria

No full-site blue/red logo palette flooding. Brand colours are signals, not wallpaper.

No glassmorphism as a default visual language.

No generic rounded SaaS cards on public marketing pages.

No bento grid simply because a section contains multiple facts.

No universal fade-up reveals.

No hover-scale-everything.

No custom cursor used as a “premium” badge.

No auto-rotating mobile carousels.

No long preloader that blocks useful content.

No hero that hides Shop/Send until the cinematic sequence finishes.

No all-pages-as-homepage motion intensity.

No mobile horizontal truck scaled so small it loses authority.

No unverified logistics/commerce claims.

No use-all-110-images quota.

No Motion + GSAP controlling the same transform.

No smooth-scroll engine on top of Lenis.

No experimental transition API as single point of failure.

No Playwright in the redesign QA program.

No direct editing of dashboards as part of this scope.

Appendix A. Compulsory Motion Allocation

Technique	Assigned Role
Framer/Motion	Variant selection, filters/layout rearrangement, drawers, sheets, tabs, cart line insertion, product shared layout.
GSAP	Flagship scroll sequences, pinning, masks, route lines, vehicle/courier journeys, section takeovers.
Lenis Smooth Scroll	Desktop marketing continuity only; native touch/reduced-motion elsewhere.
Page Transition	Image expansion/shared actor/quiet route families depending route.
Parallax Scroll	Marketing media layers and route worlds.
Mask Cursor Effect	Selected media galleries / campaign imagery on fine-pointer desktop.
Smooth-scroll Card Parallax	Editorial category/merchant/story rails where card depth is meaningful.
Curved Menu	Expanded global navigation reveal.
Zoom Parallax	Trailer/media takeovers and selected large image transitions.
Parallax Section Transition	Homepage and flagship marketing chapter handoffs.
Sticky Cursor	Service atlas/category explorer active media pointer.
Side Menu	Mobile/expanded secondary navigation.
Reveal Animation	Content/media entry; not universal fade-up.
Pixel Transition	Tracking/developer/system transition only, using real visual information.
Navigation Menu Interactions	Desktop atlas menu + mobile application shell.
Floating Image Gallery	About/merchant/ecosystem storytelling.
On-scroll Parallax	Route/environment depth.
Text Parallax	Oversized typography behind protagonists.
Mouse Interactive Gallery	Category/media exploration on fine pointer.
Split Vignette Effect	Selected dual-story editorial sections.
Scroll Opacity	Atmosphere, depth and handoff preparation; never sole interaction cue.

Appendix B. Research Sources

The following sources informed the final direction. They are evidence inputs, not templates to copy.

United Carriers — live site — <https://unitedcarriers.com/>

United Carriers — “How an Australian Freight Forwarder’s Website Unexpectedly Went Viral” — <https://unitedcarriers.com/insights/how-an-australian-freight-forwarders-website-unexpectedly-went-viral>

Oryzo BTS Part 1 — Concept and Creative Direction — <https://blog.lusion.co/oryzo-bts-part-1-7-concept-and-creative-direction>

Oryzo BTS Part 2 — 3D Design and Motion Graphics — <https://blog.lusion.co/oryzo-bts-part-2-7-3d-design-and-motion-graphics>

Oryzo BTS Part 3 — Website UX/UI and Illustrations — <https://blog.lusion.co/oryzo-bts-part-3-7-website-ux-ui-and-illustrations>

OFF+BRAND — Lando Norris case study — <https://www.itsoffbrand.com/our-work/lando-norris>

Baymard — Mobile App UX Trends — <https://baymard.com/research-articles/mobile-app-ux-trends>

Baymard — Ecommerce Category Pages — <https://baymard.com/learn/ecommerce-category-page>

Baymard — Product Lists & Filtering UX — <https://baymard.com/research/ecommerce-product-lists>

Baymard — Mobile Product Lists — <https://baymard.com/mcommerce-usability/benchmark/mobile-page-types/product-list>

Baymard — Mobile Ecommerce Usability — <https://baymard.com/research/mcommerce-usability>

GSAP ScrollTrigger documentation — <https://gsap.com/docs/v3/Plugins/ScrollTrigger/>

Motion for React — layout animations — <https://motion.dev/docs/react-layout-animations>

web.dev — Responsive Images — <https://web.dev/learn/design/responsive-images>

Awwwards — historical award weighting / evaluation examples — <https://www.awwwards.com/>

KT Courier repository — <https://github.com/analyticsmath/KT-Courier>

Valtum Studio UI/UX + Creative Frontend Brain — User-provided internal design authority document.

Valtum Studio Reference Corpus Report — User-provided internal reference research document.

KT Courier redesign/codebase audit — User-provided /docs/REDESIGN_CODEBASE_AUDIT.md equivalent attachment.

User-provided visual reference set — Royal Beverage hero; White Desert transitions/footer; United Carriers screenshots; marketplace/category/product references; clipping and image-field references; mobile/commerce references.

Final Design Authority Statement

KT Courier should feel like a continuous physical system in which commerce becomes movement.

The public redesign is ready to proceed to implementation handoff once this blueprint is accepted. The next artifact should be the coding-agent .md, not another ideation document.

That handoff must instruct the coding agent to inspect the local media root first, preserve real product/business logic, rebuild public visual architecture directly in the existing routes, implement mobile and reduced-motion versions in parallel, and verify the experience manually across the defined viewport matrix.

The award-level ambition should remain a quality bar rather than a promise of an award. Success is a site that is visually authored enough to compete for recognition while remaining faster, clearer, more credible and more useful than the current experience.